FREE GUIDE · VA CHALLENGES EP 2

Graveyard Shift and Isolation: A Healthier Routine

Isolation and night shifts are some of the most common challenges Filipino VAs describe. Small habits help.

Time (PH)	Example routine for a US client
9:00 PM	Start shift. Hardest task first
2:00 AM	Real meal and a short break away from the screen
6:00 AM	End shift. Send the EOD report and close the laptop
7:00 AM	Sleep 7 to 8 hours in a dark, cool room
3:00 PM	Sunlight, movement, family and friends

Sleep checklist

☐ Same sleep time every day, weekends too
☐ Blackout curtains or an eye mask
☐ No coffee in the hours before sleep
☐ Phone on do not disturb
☐ Tell your household your sleep hours

Body checklist

☐ Move for at least 15 minutes
☐ Some sunlight after waking up
☐ Real food, not only coffee and noodles
☐ 20-20-20: every 20 minutes, look 20 feet away for 20 seconds

BALANCE · VA CHALLENGES EP 2

Beat isolation

Remote work can feel lonely. Plan connection like you plan work.

Sign	What to try
Days with no real conversation	Join a VA community or co-working space
Only work, no rest	One full offline day every week
Irritable or tired even after sleep	Review your sleep and workload
Avoiding people	Schedule time with a friend this week

Talk to your client about

- ☐ An earlier shift if possible
- ☐ Tasks that can be done async
- ☐ Shift hours written in your agreement
- ☐ Day-off requests made early

If things feel heavy for a long time, talk to someone you trust or a professional. NCMH Crisis Hotline (Philippines): 1553 or 0919-057-1553. This guide is general wellness information, not medical advice.